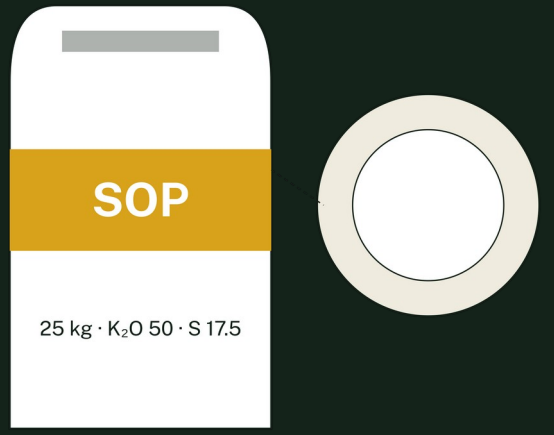
DEALER TRAINING · NOVEMBER 2026

SOP



Sulfate of potash: K_2O 50%, sulfur 17.5% and no chloride, in a 25 kg bag. It goes on the soil at or before sowing, never by drone.

VAN wrote this deck for its dealers and field team. A dealer can repeat its words to a grower.

THE 30-SECOND EXPLANATION

What a dealer says to a grower in 30 seconds.

SOP is sulfate of potash: K_2O 50%, sulfur 17.5% and no chloride, in a 25 kg bag. It supplies potash as muriate of potash (MOP) does, but it carries sulfur where MOP carries chloride. Having no chloride matters on saline or sodic soil, where chloride adds to the salt that already makes it harder for the root to take up water, and on chloride-sensitive crops such as potato, tobacco and most fruit. The sulfur is sulfate, which the root takes up directly, so it counts towards the season's sulfur. SOP is a basal fertiliser only: drill it at sowing, or broadcast it before the last ploughing if there is no drill. It is never applied by drone. VAN buys SOP from a supplier and sells it under the VAN name; for the paperwork on your lot, ask VAN.

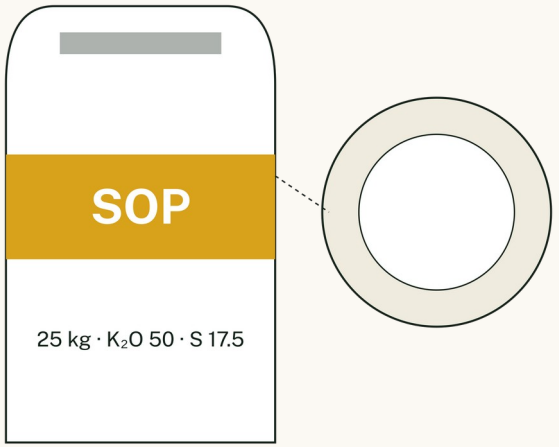
The 4 points it must cover

1. The bag: K_2O 50%, S 17.5%, no chloride, 25 kg. 12.5 kg of K_2O and 4.4 kg of sulfur in every bag.
2. The reason to buy it: it contains no chloride, which matters on saline ground and on chloride-sensitive crops.
3. The sulfur: 17.5% as sulfate; count it towards the season's sulfur. The plant needs sulfur to turn nitrogen into protein.
4. The method: basal only. Drill it at sowing, or broadcast it before the last ploughing. It is never applied by drone.

Explain the product in simple words a grower uses, and keep to the figures on these slides. Every figure in this 30-second explanation is on the bag or in the named evidence on the slides that follow.

THE BAG

What the bag says, and how it is registered.



25 kg

the bag. Every bag holds 12.5 kg of K_2O and 4.4 kg of sulfur by the declared analysis.

K_2O 50%

potash by weight, declared on the front of the bag.

S 17.5%

sulfur by weight, as sulfate: the form the root takes up, available as soon as it dissolves.

0 chloride

the main reason to choose SOP.

Basal only

on the soil, at or before sowing. It is not a drone or ultra-low-volume grade, and VAN will not make a drone grade of it.

LAB 336

VAN buys SOP from a supplier and sells it under the VAN name; no VAN licence applies to it. Each batch is tested in VAN Lab before dispatch.

Registered as	Pakistan Standard	Manufacturing licence
SOP	Ask VAN	No VAN licence: ask VAN

This product has no VAN licence number to quote. If a grower asks about registration, refer him to VAN.

A GROWER'S QUESTION

“MOP is cheaper potash. Why would I pay more for SOP?”

Dealers hear this question wherever SOP is sold beside MOP. The honest answer starts by agreeing that, for each kilogram of potash, MOP is cheaper. The reason to buy SOP is that it contains no chloride and carries sulfur instead. The answer has 3 parts: chloride, sulfur, and how the bag is applied.

The next 3 slides give the 3 answers, 1 idea on each slide.

ANSWER 1 OF 3

SOP supplies potash without chloride, and that is the main reason to buy it.

Muriate of potash (MOP) is potassium chloride. The crop needs only a little chloride, and it gets that from rain and canal water. The chloride added with MOP stays in the soil solution and does the crop no good. In the Punjab soil survey (770,160 samples, tested in about 2016 to 2018), 9.0% of samples tested saline. On saline or sodic soil, any extra salt makes it harder for the root to take up water. On chloride-sensitive crops, such as potato, tobacco, most fruit and many horticultural crops, chloride itself lowers quality. SOP is potassium sulfate: it supplies K_2O with sulfur instead of chloride, and it carries a lower salt load per bag than MOP.



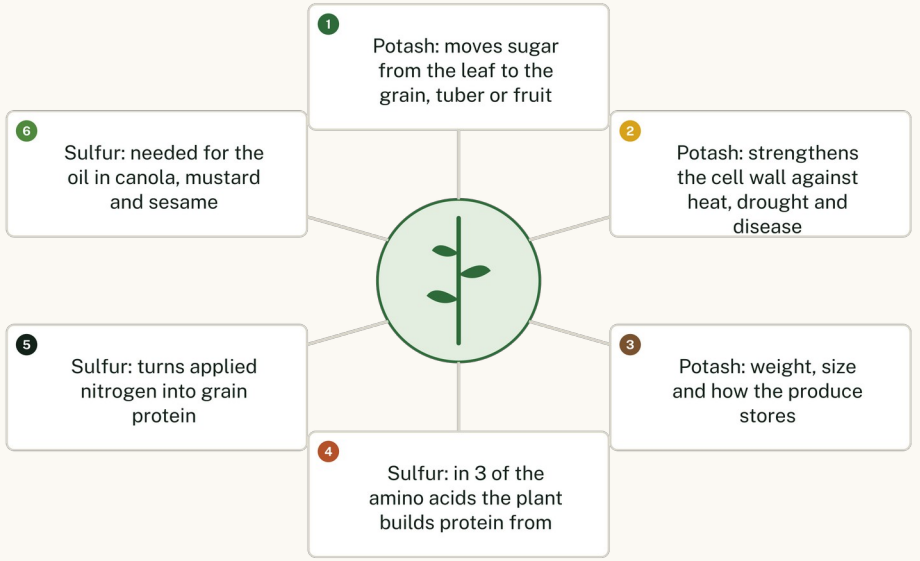
What is in each bag. MOP is a general product name; VAN prints no MOP price and no competitor brand.

Say it like this: “For each kilogram of potash, MOP is cheaper. You buy SOP because it has no chloride, which matters on salty soil and on crops that chloride harms.”

ANSWER 2 OF 3

The sulfur in SOP is a second nutrient, and it counts towards the season’s sulfur.

Every bag carries 4.4 kg of sulfur as sulfate, the form the root takes up directly. Sulfur is part of 3 of the amino acids the plant uses to build protein. Without enough sulfur, the plant cannot turn all the applied nitrogen into protein, and the unused nitrogen is lost from the field. Sulfur is also needed for the oil in canola, mustard and sesame. Sulfate moves with the soil water, so count its sulfur only in the season the bag is applied, as part of that season’s total sulfur. VAN’s soil test report does not include sulfur, so VAN claims no national figure for sulfur shortage; van.com.pk states this.



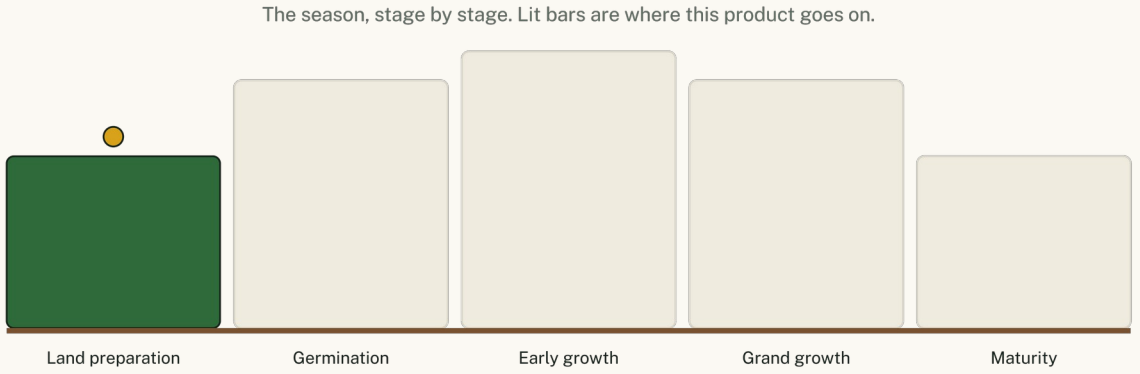
The 6 jobs of potash and sulfur, from the 17-nutrients page on van.com.pk. The drawing illustrates the idea; it is not a measurement.

Say it like this: “This bag carries 4.4 kg of sulfur that the root can take up. Count this sulfur in your fertiliser plan, so you do not pay for it twice.”

ANSWER 3 OF 3

SOP goes into the soil before or at sowing, never by drone.

VAN recommends SOP as a basal fertiliser only. The best method is to drill it beside and below the seed row at sowing. If that is not possible, side-dress it in a band; broadcast it only as the last option. VAN's dose guidance of 23 July 2026 is ½ bag per acre on wheat and rice, and 1 bag per acre on sugarcane, citrus, potato and other crops. No published crop plan includes SOP yet. It is not a drone grade, and VAN will not make a drone grade of it.



Land preparation is the stage for the basal bag. The rates are VAN's guidance; no published crop plan includes SOP yet.

Say it like this: "Put it in the ground before or at sowing. VAN's guidance is ½ bag per acre on wheat and rice and 1 bag per acre on other crops. Never put it in a drone."

THE EVIDENCE

What is verified for SOP, and what is not.

No VAN trial of SOP exists. A dealer may state the following as facts, and should say where each comes from: what the bag declares, how SOP is registered, the Punjab soil survey and the published potash research.

Item	What it says	How a dealer may use it
The bag	SOP, sulfate of potash, K_2O 50% w/w, S 17.5% w/w, chloride-free, 25 kg. Basal only, on the soil.	As fact.
Registration	VAN buys SOP from a supplier and sells it under the VAN name; no VAN licence applies to it. For the paperwork on your lot, ask VAN.	Tell the grower to ask VAN about registration. Never quote a licence number for it.
The Punjab soil survey (770,160 samples, about 2016 to 2018)	87.8% of samples below 180 ppm available potassium, the level Punjab soil laboratories treat as adequate; mean 132 ppm. 9.0% tested saline; mean electrical conductivity (EC) 2.07 dS/m. Sulfur: 0 samples tested.	As fact about the soil. Never as product performance.
National potash use	In 2024-25, potash was 1% of all the fertiliser nutrients applied in Pakistan (NFDC; also printed on the Crop Force bag). In 2023, Pakistan applied about 1 kg of potash (K_2O) for every 83 kg of nitrogen (FAO).	As fact.
Published research, not VAN trials	Sindh banana (Memon et al. 2010): an improved practice, with far more potash than the farmers' own practice, raised yield. Multan cotton (Hussain, Ali and Gardezi 2021): soil potassium reduced boll shedding.	Spoken, as research on potash. Never as an SOP result.
Not on VAN's record	A trial of SOP; a crop plan row; a PS number or VAN licence; a salt-index figure; a Pakistani sulfur deficiency figure.	Not said.

Sources: the bag and van.com.pk; the regulatory page on van.com.pk; the National Fertilizer Development Centre (NFDC) for the 2024-25 potash share; FAO (2023) for the potash to nitrogen ratio; the Punjab soil survey (36 district workbooks, 770,160 samples, tested in about 2016 to 2018); Memon et al. 2010; Hussain, Ali and Gardezi 2021.

On wheat, ½ bag of SOP costs Rs 4,000 per acre and supplies 6.25 kg of K_2O and 2.2 kg of sulfur.

The price is the delivered farmer price from the VAN farmer price sheet, August 2026. K_2O and sulfur are from the declared analysis. Rates are VAN's dose guidance of 23 July 2026; no published crop plan includes SOP yet.

SOP, K_2O 50% · S 17.5%	Weight	K_2O	Sulfur	Rupees
1 bag	25 kg	12.5 kg	4.4 kg	8,000
Wheat or rice, ½ bag an acre	**12.5 kg**	**6.25 kg**	**2.2 kg**	**4,000**
Sugarcane, citrus, potato, 1 bag an acre	**25 kg**	**12.5 kg**	**4.4 kg**	**8,000**

On wheat, the grower spends Rs 4,000 per acre to put 6.25 kg of K_2O and 2.2 kg of sulfur in the ground, with no chloride. VAN publishes no figure for how much of this potash and sulfur the crop takes up, and no yield figure.

SOP 25 kg Rs 8,000: the VAN farmer price sheet, August 2026. 12.5 kg = 25 × 0.50; 4.4 kg = 25 × 0.175. Rates: VAN's dose guidance of 23 July 2026.

An acre of wheat at 40 maunds, with its straw, takes out an estimated 40 kg of K_2O; ½ bag of SOP puts in 6.25 kg.

Estimated potash and sulfur taken out in the harvested crop on 1 acre of wheat at 40 maunds (1.6 tonnes), from the IPNI (International Plant Nutrition Institute) removal tables used on van.com.pk, compared with ½ bag of SOP.

Wheat, 1 acre at 40 maunds	K_2O at 1.6 t	Sulfur at 1.6 t	
Grain taken out (K_2O 4.8, S 1.7 per tonne)	7.7 kg	2.7 kg	
Straw (bhusa) taken out too (K_2O 20, S 2.3 per tonne of grain)	32 kg	3.7 kg	
Grain and straw together	**40 kg**	**6.4 kg**	
SOP, ½ bag at land preparation, puts in	**6.25 kg**	**2.2 kg**	

Where the bhusa is also removed, the crop takes out an estimated 40 kg of K_2O and 6.4 kg of sulfur per acre. ½ bag of SOP puts back 6.25 kg of K_2O and 2.2 kg of sulfur. The rest of the potash comes from potassium already in the soil, and in the Punjab soil survey (about 2016 to 2018), 87.8% of samples had less than 180 ppm of available potassium, the level Punjab soil laboratories treat as adequate. These figures show how much potash and sulfur a 40-maund wheat crop takes out of the field, against what ½ bag of SOP puts back; they are not a yield claim.

IPNI nutrient removal tables (metric, 01/15): wheat grain K_2O 4.8 and S 1.7; straw K_2O 20 and S 2.3 per tonne of grain. 40 maunds × 40 kg = 1.6 t. Soil: the Punjab soil survey (about 2016 to 2018), 87.8% of samples below 180 ppm available potassium, the level Punjab soil laboratories treat as adequate. No Pakistani removal table exists on the public record, as van.com.pk says.

VAN's 3 potash bags do 3 different jobs.

Bag prices side by side, from the VAN farmer price sheet, August 2026. The dealer sells each bag for its stage and job, never on price per kilogram.

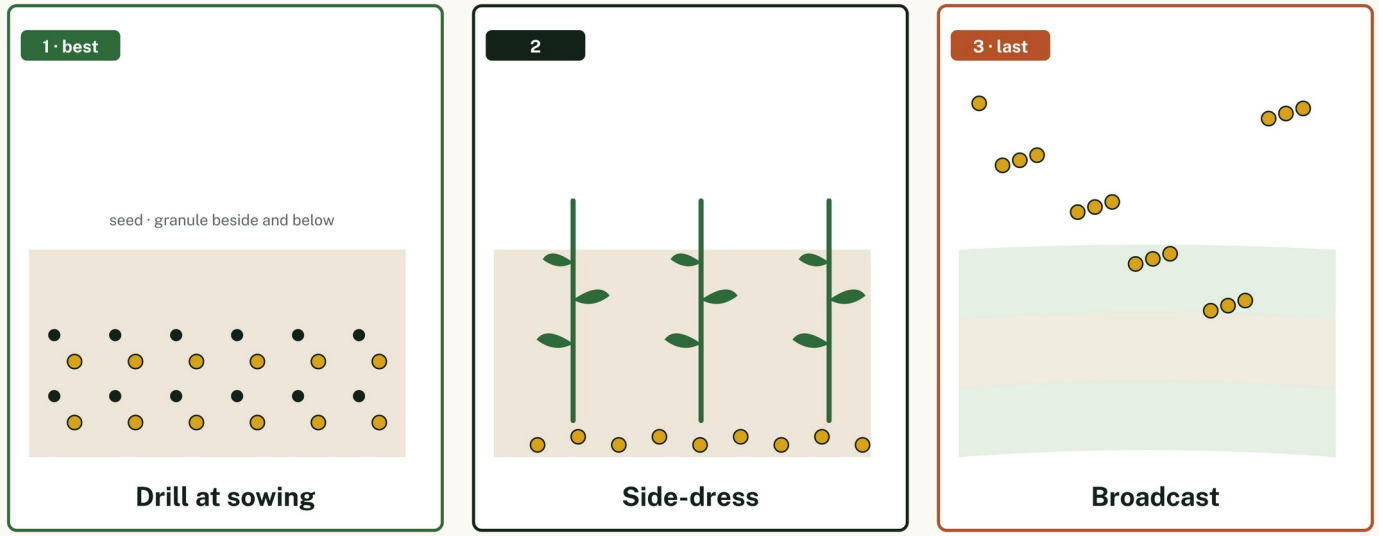
Product	Bag	K_2O in the bag	Stage and method	Rupees
SOP, K_2O 50% · S 17.5%, no chloride	25 kg	12.5 kg	Land preparation, drilled or broadcast	8,000
Fusion Potash, K_2O 50% with S, B, Mg	25 kg	12.5 kg	Land preparation, drilled or broadcast	11,500
Vital Potash, N 11% · K_2O 44%	20 kg	8.8 kg	At the stages each crop plan gives, most often grand growth and maturity, through the water	10,500

SOP and Fusion Potash both go into the soil before or at sowing. Choose SOP where chloride or salt is a problem and sulfur is needed, and Fusion Potash where boron and magnesium are needed. Vital Potash goes through the irrigation water at the stages each crop plan gives, most often grand growth and maturity. MOP is not on the VAN price sheet, so no price is given for it.

Prices: the VAN farmer price sheet, August 2026, SOP 25 kg Rs 8,000; Fusion Potash 25 kg Rs 11,500; Vital Potash 20 kg Rs 10,500. K_2O per bag from the declared analyses.

HOW IT IS APPLIED

SOP goes into the soil before or at sowing, never by drone.



Drill at sowing, best

The seed drill's fertiliser box places the granule about 5 cm beside and below the seed row, never touching the seed. The young root reaches the drilled granule first, and all of the fertiliser is in the root zone.

Side-dress second, broadcast last

Side-dress it in a band beside the row, covered with soil, at sowing or the first irrigation. Where there is no drill, spread it before the last ploughing and mix it in; this is the last option. Granules left on the surface do not reach the root.

Basal only, never by drone

VAN recommends SOP as a basal fertiliser only: it goes on the soil at or before sowing. It is not a drone or ultra-low-volume grade, and it is never flown.

Drilling is best, side-dressing next, broadcasting last.

VAN gives this order for every basal granule it sells. The crop's response to the same fertiliser depends on where it is placed.

Preference	Method	What it means	Why
1 · best	Drill at sowing	The seed drill's fertiliser box places the granule about 5 cm beside and below the seed row, never touching the seed.	The root reaches a drilled granule sooner than a side-dressed or broadcast one. The granule has the least contact with air, sun and free calcium at the surface, and all of the fertiliser is placed in the root zone.
2 · second best	Side-dress	The granules are placed in a band beside the row, by hand or with a planter, at sowing or at the first irrigation, and covered with soil.	The band is still near the root, but it goes on later and shallower than a drilled granule.
3 · last option	Broadcast	The granules are spread on the surface before the last ploughing or before an irrigation, and mixed in.	Most of the fertiliser lies away from the root, and most of it stays near the surface, in contact with air, sun and free calcium.

In VAN's own fields and partner fields, on wheat, maize and sugarcane, basal fertiliser drilled at sowing has given 7 to 9% more yield per acre than the same bag broadcast: the mean of replicated observations across regions, not a published trial.

VAN recommends SOP as a basal fertiliser only. It goes on the soil at or before sowing; choose the method in this order.

OBJECTION 1 OF 7

“8,000 for 25 kg? MOP is cheaper and it is the same 50% potash.”

What the dealer says

You are right that MOP is cheaper for each kilogram of potash, but it is not the same: MOP is potassium chloride, 60% potash. On salty soil, and on chloride-sensitive crops such as potato, tobacco and most fruit, the chloride harms the crop. SOP has no chloride, and it carries 4.4 kg of sulfur a bag that you would otherwise buy separately. If your soil is not salty and your crop tolerates chloride, MOP may be the right bag. Tell me about the field and the crop.

The facts behind the answer

- SOP 25 kg Rs 8,000 (VAN farmer price sheet, August 2026). MOP carries no price on the VAN sheet.
- 12.5 kg K_2O and 4.4 kg S per bag (the declared analysis); MOP is potassium chloride, K_2O 60, no sulfur.
- Chloride-sensitive crops: potato, tobacco, most fruit and many horticultural crops (general agronomy).

Never say: “SOP gives more yield than MOP.” No trial on VAN’s record says so.

OBJECTION 2 OF 7

“Can I fly it in the drone with my spray?”

What the dealer says

No. SOP is a basal fertiliser. It goes into the soil before or at sowing. It is not a drone or ultra-low-volume grade, and VAN will not present it as one. Only products designed from the start for the drone are in VAN’s One Tank family, and SOP is not one of them.

The facts behind the answer

- SOP is not a drone grade, and VAN will not make a drone grade of it (the application systems page on van.com.pk).
- VAN recommends SOP as a basal fertiliser only, on the soil at or before sowing.
- Only a product designed from the start for the drone is named in VAN’s One Tank family; SOP stays outside it (van.com.pk).

Never say: “It dissolves, so it will fly.”

OBJECTION 3 OF 7

“Which stage do I put it on?”

What the dealer says

Put it in the ground before or at sowing: drill it beside and below the seed row if you have a drill; if not, broadcast it before the last ploughing and mix it in. VAN recommends it as a basal fertiliser only. VAN’s guidance of 23 July 2026 is ½ bag per acre on wheat and rice and 1 bag per acre on sugarcane, citrus, potato and other crops. No published crop plan includes SOP yet, so I can give you only the guidance.

The facts behind the answer

- SOP is a basal granule: drilled at sowing, or broadcast before sowing where there is no drill.
- Rates per acre: VAN’s dose guidance of 23 July 2026, wheat and rice ½ bag; sugarcane, citrus, potato and other crops 1 bag.
- No published crop plan on van.com.pk includes SOP.

Never say or give: any stage or rate that VAN’s guidance does not name, or any foliar rate.

OBJECTION 4 OF 7

“Is it registered? Where is VAN’s licence for it?”

What the dealer says

VAN buys SOP from a supplier and sells it under the VAN name; no VAN licence applies to it. Each batch is tested at VAN Lab before dispatch. For the paperwork on your lot, ask VAN; I will not quote a licence number that does not apply to this product.

The facts behind the answer

- VAN buys SOP from a supplier and sells it under the VAN name; no VAN licence applies to it (the SOP page on van.com.pk).
- 20 of VAN’s 23 brands hold a live manufacturing licence from PSQCA (the Pakistan Standards and Quality Control Authority). SOP is 1 of the 3 that do not, and van.com.pk states why. Figures as of July 2026.

Never say or give: any PS number or CM/L number for SOP.

OBJECTION 5 OF 7

“My land is salty. Will this fix it?”

What the dealer says

It will not fix salinity, and VAN does not say it will. It puts on potash and sulfur without adding chloride to a soil solution that is already salty, so the root does not have to cope with more salt to get its potash. On saline or sodic soil, that is the reason to choose this bag. Salinity is managed through drainage and irrigation water, not through fertiliser, and the first step is a soil test.

The facts behind the answer

- 9.0% of samples tested saline; mean electrical conductivity (EC, a measure of salt) 2.07 dS/m (the Punjab soil survey, 770,160 samples, about 2016 to 2018).
- Sulfate of potash carries a lower salt load per bag than potassium chloride (general soil chemistry; no salt-index figure is given).
- VAN claims no change in a soil test or in EC for any of its potash products.

Never say: “It cures saline soil” or “it lowers your EC”.

OBJECTION 6 OF 7

“If there is sulfur in it, do I still need Green Sulfur?”

What the dealer says

Count what this bag supplies: 4.4 kg of sulfur a bag, as sulfate, available to the root this season. If your crop plan includes Green Sulfur, keep it in the plan, and count the sulfur from SOP as part of the season’s total, not as an extra. VAN does not say that one replaces the other. How much sulfur you need depends on your crop plan and your field.

The facts behind the answer

- 4.4 kg S per bag = 25 × 0.175.
- Sulfate is the form the root takes up; elemental sulfur must be turned into sulfate by soil bacteria first (the Green Sulfur page on van.com.pk).
- A wheat crop of 40 maunds per acre takes out an estimated 6.4 kg of sulfur when the bhusa (straw) is also removed (IPNI removal tables).

Never say: “SOP replaces Green Sulfur” or “you never need sulfur again”.

OBJECTION 7 OF 7

“Is SOP organic? Can I use it on my organic plot?”

What the dealer says

VAN does not print “organic” on this bag and I will not say it. SOP is a mineral potash, sulfate of potash. Whether a particular certifier accepts it on an organic plot is that certifier’s rule, not VAN’s claim. Ask the certifier, with the bag in hand.

The facts behind the answer

- The word “organic” is not on the bag or on the product page (van.com.pk).
- SOP is a mineral salt, potassium sulfate (general chemistry).
- VAN makes no organic claim for any potash.

Never say: “It is organic-approved.”

ITS PLACE IN THE CROP PLANS

No published crop plan includes SOP yet.

No published crop plan on van.com.pk includes SOP yet, so no rate per crop is published. VAN’s dose guidance of 23 July 2026 is ½ bag per acre on wheat and rice and 1 bag per acre on sugarcane, citrus, potato and other crops, drilled or broadcast at or before sowing. A dealer quotes it as VAN’s guidance and sends the grower to VAN for a written plan.

WHAT VAN DOES NOT CLAIM FOR THIS PRODUCT

A dealer who makes any of these claims is speaking for himself, not for VAN.

1. A yield figure, or that SOP beats MOP. No trial on VAN's record shows it.
2. That it fixes or cures saline soil, or lowers the soil's EC. It adds no chloride, but it does not reduce the salt already in the soil.
3. A drone or ultra-low-volume use. It goes on the soil only, and VAN will not make a drone grade of it.
4. A VAN licence or Pakistan Standard number. VAN buys SOP from a supplier; for the paperwork on your lot, ask VAN.
5. "Organic." The word is not on the bag and VAN does not claim it.
6. That it replaces Green Sulfur or Vital Potash. Count its sulfur as part of the season's total sulfur.

HOW A GROWER VERIFIES A BAG

Every batch is tested, and the batch number on the bag identifies its certificate.

1 · The batch number

Every bag carries the batch number. Read it to the grower and show him where it is printed.

2 · The certificate of analysis

On van.com.pk, a grower can read the certificate of analysis for any bag by entering the batch number printed on it. The grower does not need to post a sample.

3 · The laboratory

VAN Lab is accredited by the Pakistan National Accreditation Council (PNAC) to ISO/IEC 17025:2017, the international standard for testing laboratories, as LAB 336. Every batch is released through the laboratory before it ships. The certificate carries the laboratory's number.

What a grower may ask about an SOP bag

The grower may ask for the declared analysis, K_2O 50% and S 17.5%, and for the batch number on the bag. Each batch of SOP is tested at VAN Lab, PNAC LAB 336, before dispatch. VAN buys SOP from a supplier and sells it under the VAN name; no VAN licence applies to it. For the paperwork on the grower's lot, the dealer asks VAN.

THE URDU LINES · REVIEW STATUS UNDER EACH LINE

The lines a dealer says in Urdu.

The first line is the product's main message. Where its nutrient has one, the line gives VAN's promise word: the 1-word brand message VAN uses for that nutrient. The other 3 lines are key sentences of this deck. Each English line gives the meaning of the Urdu beside it. Send any correction to partner@van.com.pk.

Promise word GUARD: "the crop's shield".

فصل کی ڈھال

English meaning · Urdu reviewed 27 Sep 2026

Potash without chloride, and with sulfur.

پوٹاش، کلورائیڈ کے بغیر، سلفر کے ساتھ

English meaning · Urdu line pending review

In the soil at land preparation. Never by drone.

زمین کی تیاری پر مٹی میں دیں یا پانی کے ساتھ، ڈرون سے کبھی نہیں

English meaning · Urdu line pending review

Buy it because it contains no chloride.

اسے اس لیے خریدیں کہ اس میں کلورائیڈ نہیں

English meaning · Urdu reviewed 27 Sep 2026

TALK TO VAN

Use the address that matches your request.

For growers

kisan@van.com.pk

A crop plan, product rates, a certificate for your batch or a dealer near you.

For the trade

partner@van.com.pk

Dealers, distributors and the trade: stock, training and corrections to this deck.

For everything else

info@van.com.pk

Supply, the laboratory or a plant visit.

Helpline 0300 5003041 · www.van.com.pk

Vital Agri Nutrients (Pvt) Ltd, Lahore, has 1 helpline and 3 addresses. VAN sends no group messages; every grower who writes gets a direct reply.

SOP supplies potash without chloride, and with sulfur. It goes into the soil before or at sowing, never by drone.

